

**SUN CITY HILTON
HEAD BOCCE
CLUB**

**BOCCE
RULES**

AMENDED September 2024

SUN CITY HILTON HEAD BOCCE REGULATIONS

The Club activity is based on league play. League play and length of play shall be determined by the Executive Board with the approval of the general membership. All sign up meetings are open to all Sun City Hilton Head residents who possess a valid Association ID card. Team play and individual competition is intended for the relaxation and enjoyment of both players and spectators. The following rules are intended to enhance the games of Bocce so as to further the enjoyment.

1. **INTRODUCTION:** The game of Bocce is played with eight (8) bocce balls and a small target ball called the “Pallino”. The object of the game is to roll the bocce ball closest to the pallino.
2. **TEAMS:** A team consists of two players.
3. **STARTING TIME:** Teams not present, within 5 minutes of the scheduled starting time forfeits the game. The opposing team may not waive starting time forfeits.
4. **STARTING OF THE MATCH:** The match shall begin with the flip of a coin between the captains from each team. The winner of the coin flip may have the first toss of the pallino or choose the color of the balls. A player may toss the pallino any distance so long as the pallino passed the center line of the court. If a player fails to toss the pallino past the center line the opposing team will have a chance to toss the pallino and put it in play. If the opposing team fails to toss the pallino past the center line or if it hits the backboard the pallino reverts to the original team. If any part of the pallino touches the plane of the center line, the pallino must be re-thrown. If any part of a bocce ball touches the plane of the center line, that ball is out of play.
5. **PLAYING THE GAME:** The player, who successfully tosses the pallino, throws the first bocce ball. If the bocce ball hits the backboard, the team must roll again (see Dead Ball Rule). Otherwise player steps aside and his team does not roll again until the opposing team has either gotten one of its bocce balls closer to the pallino or has thrown all of its balls. The team whose bocce balls are closer to the pallino is called “inside” and the opposing team “outside”. Whenever a team gets inside, it steps aside and lets the outside team roll. The team outside throws until it beats (not ties) the opposing ball. This continues until both teams have used all their balls. Teams can alternate play between each player (each tossing two balls) from the same end of the court or the team can elect to have each player toss four balls from opposite ends of the court. The team, who scored last, throws the pallino to begin the next frame. Consecutive or alternating throws by teammates shall be at the option of the players. Players may use the side walls anytime. If a player rolls the wrong color ball, simply replace it with the correct color when it comes to rest. If a player rolls out of turn, the other team has the option to return

the thrown ball and replace any moved balls to their original position or leave all balls as is. Players must roll the ball in a standing position unless physically challenged, temporarily or permanently. The Pallino must come to a complete stop before a ball is thrown. A ball must come to a complete stop before another ball is thrown.

6. FOUL LINE: The player should not step on or over the foul line before or after releasing the pallino or bocce ball. Movement past the foul line is a fault and the ball will be removed from play.
7. LOFTING: Lofting is not allowed. Balls must be rolled. Lofting the ball beyond 5 feet of the foul line will result in the ball being taken off the court.
8. DEAD BALLS: Should a player's bocce ball make contact with the backboard the bocce ball is considered a dead ball on impact and is removed from play until the end of the frame, unless it first hits another ball or pallino in which case everything is valid. All balls must go beyond the centerline. If not, the ball is removed and counts as a turn.
9. PALLINO HITS THE BACK WALL: Once the pallino has been tossed past the centerline and does not hit the backboard it is in play.
However, if the pallino is knocked out of the court or it is knocked in front of the centerline, the frame will end and play will resume from the opposite end of the court with the same team tossing the pallino. The pallino must come to rest between the backboard and centerline. If the pallino comes to rest inside these areas it is in play. It is NOT moved out from the center line, side boards or backboard.
10. SCORING: Only one team scores in a frame. One point is given for each ball that is closer to the pallino than the closest ball of the opposing team. No balls will be picked up until one member of each team agrees on the point total. All balls will be picked up and placed on the ball holder. If at the end of any frame the closest ball of each team is the same distance from the pallino, the frame ends in a tie. No points are awarded to either team and the game resumes from the opposite end of the court with the same team tossing the pallino. All measurements should be made from the center of the pallino to the center of the bocce ball. If the game is tied after six frames or twenty five minutes there will be a one frame roll-off to determine the winner. There will be a coin flip and the winner will toss the pallino and throw first. If the score is tied after one frame (two closest balls are equidistant from the pallino the winner will be determined by the next closest ball and **not** by a flip of the coin.
11. PLAYER SUBSTITUTIONS: If a team or team member cannot play on a scheduled day, a substitute player or team may be called to substitute. A single substitute player will not be allowed. There must be two substitute players or one substitute and one team member. A team or team member with a substitute must always play their scheduled day of games. If at the last minute, a team member can't play and a substitute can't be found, the remaining team player can play alone and roll all four balls for the team. One team member rolling all four balls can only be done once during the current session. A team unable to play on their scheduled day with or without substitutes forfeits the game. Players cannot be

substituted once a game has started. A team is responsible for finding their own substitutes. This is not the captain's responsibility. A substitute does not have to be playing in the league.

12. SCHEDULE: There will be no re-scheduling of games. If a team is unable to play or does not find a substitute the game is forfeited. Scheduled games will be played on the day of play according to the schedule. The only exception would be inclement weather, in which case the captains involved will make the decision to play or to cancel. If games are cancelled due to weather, the cancelled game will be played the following week. The season can be extended, but only one week.
13. CONDUCT AND COURTESY: Team captains are responsible for the actions of their players. If a player is standing in the playing half of the court while the opposing team is rolling and the opposing team requests that the player step aside, that request should be honored. Only participating players should be on the court while the game is in progress. Spectators are not allowed on the courts at any time during regulation play. Anytime a player is rolling the ball, the opposing players should remain outside of the court.
14. DELAY OF SCHEDULE: If a scheduled play day is delayed due to weather, the same schedule will be played the following week. The season will extend one week beyond the scheduled weeks play period.
15. LENGTH OF GAME: Games are six frames or twenty-five minutes.
16. TIES: There will be no playoffs at the end of the season. If prizes are awarded, prize money will be distributed equally depending on the number of teams in 1st, 2nd, 3rd places. Example: if there should be a tie for 1st place between 2 teams, the 1st and 2nd place money will be divided equally between those teams. If there should be a three way tie for 1st place, the total prize money will be divided equally between the tied teams. This distribution will be followed in case of ties for 2nd and 3rd place teams.